PROJECT: ANALYZING STUDENTS' MENTAL HEALTH

datalab

Does going to university in a different country affect your mental health? A Japanese international university surveyed its students in 2018 and published a study the following year that was approved by several ethical and regulatory boards.

The study found that international students have a higher risk of mental health difficulties than the general population, and that social connectedness (belonging to a social group) and acculturative stress (stress associated with joining a new culture) are predictive of depression.

Explore the `students` data using PostgreSQL to find out if you would come to a similar conclusion for international students and see if the length of stay is a contributing factor.

Here is a data description of the columns you may find helpful.

Field Name	Description
`inter_dom`	Types of students (international or domestic)
`japanese_cate`	Japanese language proficiency
`english_cate`	English language proficiency
`academic`	Current academic level (undergraduate or graduate)
`age`	Current age of student
`stay`	Current length of stay in years
`todep`	Total score of depression (PHQ-9 test)
`tosc`	Total score of social connectedness (SCS test)
`toas`	Total score of acculturative stress (ASISS test)

Projects Data DataFrame as students

```
-- Run this code to view the data in students
SELECT *
FROM students;
```

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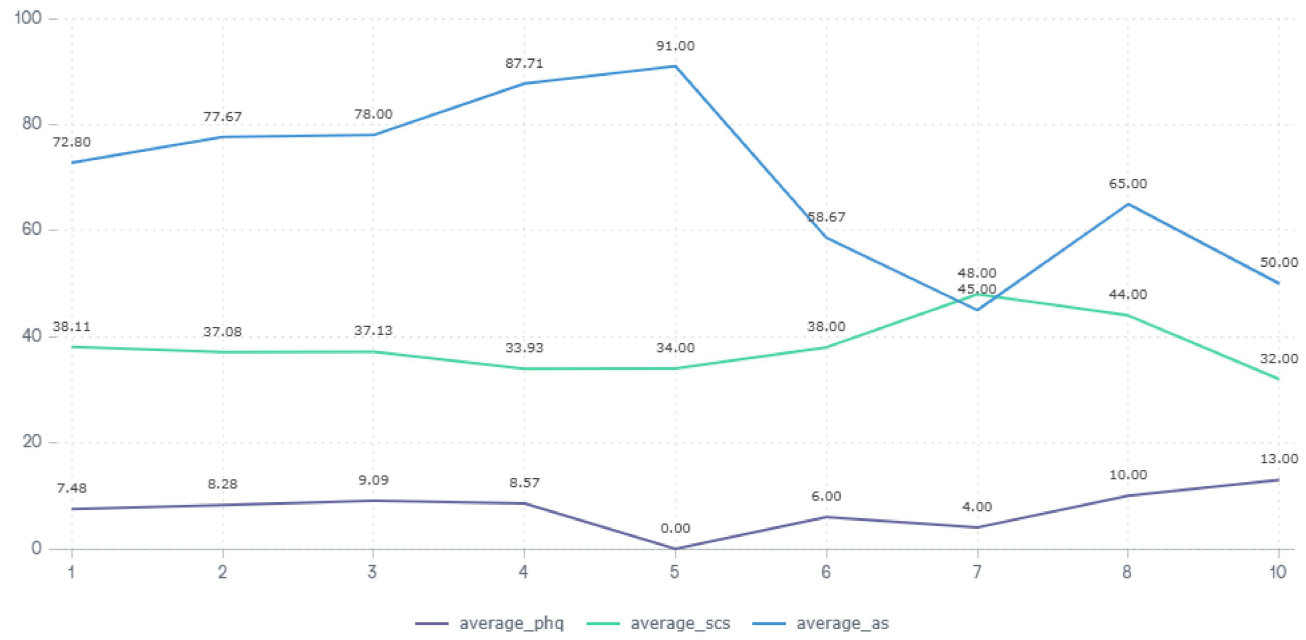
0	Inter	SEA	Male	Grad	24	4	5	Long	3	Average	5	High
1	Inter	SEA	Male	Grad	28	5	1	Short	4	High	4	High
2	Inter	SEA	Male	Grad	25	4	6	Long	4	High	4	High
3	Inter	EA	Female	Grad	29	5	1	Short	2	Low	3	Average
4	Inter	EA	Female	Grad	28	5	1	Short	1	Low	3	Average
5	Inter	SEA	Male	Grad	24	4	6	Long	3	Average	4	High
6	Inter	SA	Male	Grad	23	4	1	Short	3	Average	5	High
7	Inter	SEA	Female	Grad	30	5	2	Medium	1	Low	1	Low
8	Inter	SEA	Female	Grad	25	4	4	Long	4	High	4	High
9	Inter	Others	Male	Grad	31	5	2	Medium	1	Low	4	High
10	Inter	Others	Female	Grad	28	5	1	Short	1	Low	2	Low
11	Inter	SEA	Female	Grad	31	5	1	Short	1	Low	4	High
12	Inter	SA	Male	Grad	29	5	1	Short	1	Low	4	High
13	Inter	EA	Male	Grad	23	4	1	Short	3	Average	4	High
14	Inter	SEA	Female	Grad	31	5	1	Short	1	Low	3	Average
15	Inter	Others	Female	Grad	30	5	1	Short	1	Low	5	High

Rows: 286 Expand

Projects Data DataFrame as df

```
-- Start coding here...
SELECT stay , count(inter_dom) as count_int ,ROUND(AVG(todep),2) AS average_phq ,
    ROUND(AVG(tosc),2) AS average_scs, ROUND(AVG(toas),2) AS average_as
FROM students
WHERE inter_dom = 'Inter'
GROUP BY stay
ORDER BY stay DESC
LIMIT 9;
```



Conclusion:

The analysis of international students in Japan shows that acculturative stress increases during the first five years of stay, instead of decreasing. For example, stress levels rise from 72.8 in the first year to 91 in the fifth year. This indicates that adapting to life in Japan is generally challenging for international students.

Possible reasons include:

1. The difficulty of learning the Japanese language.
2. Significant cultural differences and strict social norms.
3. Limited social support networks during the early years.
4. High academic pressure in Japanese universities.

Overall, the first five years abroad appear to be the most psychologically challenging, highlighting the importance of providing strong psychological and social support programs for newly arrived international students.